MIL-B-52620A(ME)
10 January 1984
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-52620(ME)
18 July 1968

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BARGE, PIER, SELF-ELEVATING, STEEL,

300 FEET BY 80 FEET BY 13 FEET

This specification is approved for use by the Belvoir Research and Development Center, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers self-elevating steel pier barges.

1.2 Classification. Pier barges shall be the following types, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Fixed installation (shoreside).
Type II - Mobile installation (shipside).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. Unless otherwise specified, the following specifications and standards of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Belvoir Research and Development Center, ATTN: STRBE-DS, Fort Belvoir, VA 22060 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 1945

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

QQ-S-781	- Strapping, Steel, and Seals.
UU-T-81	- Tags, Shipping and Stock.
PPP-B-601	- Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	- Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

MILITARY

MIL-P-116	- Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-B-121	- Barrier Material, Greaseproofed, Waterproofed, Flexible.
MIL-F-3541	- Fittings, Lubrication.
MIL-C-3600	- Compressors, Rotary, Power-Driven; and Compressors, Reciprocating, Power-Driven: Air and Gas (Except Oxygen and Refrigerant), Packaging of.
MIL-G-3859	- Grease Guns, Hand-Operated, Lever, Push and Screw Type.
MIL-G-20241	- Gasket Material, Wool Felt, Impregnated, Adhesive, Pressure-sensitive.
MIL-T-22085	- Tape, Adhesive, Preservation and Sealing.
MIL-S-81733	- Sealing and Coating Compound, Corrosion Inhibitive.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-461	- Electromagnetic Emission and Susceptibility Requirements for the Control of Electromagnetic Interference.
MIL-STD-889	- Dissimilar Metals.
MIL-STD-1186	- Cushioning, Anchoring, Bracing, Blocking and Waterproofing; with Appropriate Test Methods.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MIL-STD-1474	- Noise Limits for Army Materiel.
MS35844	- Plug, Machine Thread, Magnetic: Drain.
MS49006	- Plug, Pipe, Magnetic-Headless; Aluminum, Iron or Steel.

2.1.2 Other Government documents and drawings. The following other Government documents and drawings form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

TECHNICAL BULLETIN

TB 740-97-4	- Preservation of Vessels for Storage.

DRAWINGS

ME

TA13215E8090	- Barge, Pier, Self-Elevating, Steel, 300 feet X 80 feet X 13 feet, Fixed Installation.
TA13215E8091	- Barge, Pier, Self-Elevating, Steel 300 feet X 80 feet X 13 feet, Mobile Installation.

CONSTRUCTION SPECIFICATION

55-1945-BPL-6710-RAMP-	Specification for Construction of a Pair of Ramps for a DeLong Pier Barge.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. The issues of the documents which are indicated as DoD adopted shall be the issue listed in the current DoDISS and the supplement thereto, if applicable.

AMERICAN BUREAU OF SHIPPING (ABS)

Rules for Building and Classing Steel Vessels.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Secretary, American Bureau of Shipping, 65 Broadway, New York, NY 10006.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY OF MECHANICAL ENGINEERS (ASME)

Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code for Unfired Pressure Vessels.
Power Test Code for Displacement Compressors, Vacuum Pumps and Blowers.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society of Mechanical Engineers, Inc., 345 East 47th Street, New York, NY 10017.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Description. The pier barge shall be in accordance with TA13215E8090 for fixed installation (type I) or TA13215E8091 for mobile installation (type II) and as specified herein. The pier barge shall be a self-elevating, barge-type steel structure. It shall be capable of being towed to a site, installed and put into operation as a single or multiple pier unit.

3.1.1 Caisson. Length of caisson shall be as specified (see 6.2).

3.1.2 Ramp. When specified (see 6.2), a ramp shall be in accordance with 55-1945-BPL-6710-RAMP.

3.1.3 Drawings. The drawings forming a part of this specification are engineering design drawings. No deviation from the prescribed dimensions or tolerances is permissible without prior approval of the contracting officer. Where tolerances could cumulatively result in incorrect fits, the contractor shall provide tolerances within those prescribed on the drawings to insure correct fit, assembly, and operation of the pier barge. Any data (e.g. shop drawings, layouts, flow sheets, processing procedures, etc.) prepared by the contractor or obtained from a vendor to support fabrication and manufacture of the production item shall be made available, upon request, for inspection by the contracting officer or the designated representative.

3.2 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3 and 6.3).

3.3 Materials. Materials shall be as specified herein and on the drawings. Materials not specified shall be selected by the contractor and shall be subject to all provisions of this specification (see 6.12).

3.3.1 Material deterioration and control. The pier barge shall be fabricated from compatible materials, inherently corrosion and deterioration resistant or treated to provide protection against the various forms of corrosion and deterioration that may be encountered in any of the applicable storage and operating environment to which the item may be exposed.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.1.1 Dissimilar metals. Dissimilar metals, as defined in MIL-STD-889, shall be electrically insulated from one another to minimize or prevent galvanic corrosion. Insulation may be provided by an insulating barrier such as a coat of corrosion inhibiting sealant conforming to MIL-S-81733 or chromate tape conforming to MIL-G-20241. Protection against any galvanic corrosion could also be obtained by exclusion of the electrlyte if feasible.

3.3.1.2 Identification of materials and finishes. The contractor shall identify the specific material, material finish or treatment for use with components and sub-components, and shall make information available, upon request, to the contracting officer or designated representative.

3.4 Safety. Construction and installation shall be designed to eliminate or provide safeguards for potential operational hazards. All belts, gears, shafts, pulleys, sprockets, spindles, drums, flywheels, chains, and other reciprocating, rotating, or moving parts of equipment shall be guarded when such parts are exposed to contact by personnel or otherwise create a hazard. All hot surfaces of equipment, including exhaust pipes and other lines which may be subject to high temperatures, exposed to contact by personnel or which create a fire hazard, shall be fully guarded or insulated. All points requiring lubrication during operation shall have fittings located or guarded so as to be accessible without hazardous exposure to personnel performing these operations. Live parts of wiring or electrical equipment shall be effectively guarded and grounded to protect all persons or objects from electrical shock hazard.

3.5 Noise limits. The noise level at the operator's position of the control panel while the compressor unit is delivering rated capacity shall be within the limits of 85dB(A). If the noise level is not within these limits, the distance from the compressor unit at which 85dB(A) is met shall be determined. That distance shall be shown on noise hazard caution signs posted on the compressor units stating: "CAUTION, hearing protection required within 3 feet when equipment is operating." The caution shall be legible from the distance shown on the sign. When the caution notice is required, manuals shall include the appropriate discussion of the noise hazard in accordance with MIL-STD-1474 including the hearing protection required, the noise level of the compressor unit, and the distance from the compressor unit at which the 85dB(A) limit is met.

3.6 Maintainability. All major assemblies and installed attachments shall be accessible for maintenance, repair, and replacement without the removal of other major assemblies and installed attachments.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.7 Barge. Barge equipment and systems shall conform to drawings listed on TA13215E8090 or TA13215E8091 and to the applicable documents or publications.

3.7.1 Hull air tightness. Hull compartments formed by bulkheads shall not leak when subjected to not less than 3 pounds per square inch (psi) air pressure.

3.8 Electromagnetic interference. The electromagnetic interference emission characteristics of the pier barge shall conform to MIL-STD-461, class C1, group II.

3.9 Lubrication. Surfaces requiring lubrication shall be provided with a means for lubricating.

3.9.1 Lubrication fittings. Lubrication fittings shall conform to MIL-F-3541, types I, II or III. Fittings shall be located in a protected position and shall be accessible to a grease gun conforming to MIL-G-3859. Accessibility to fittings shall be provided without the removal or adjustment of accessories or parts. Panels and plates equipped with hand-operable, quick-disconnect fasteners may be removed to provide accessibility.

3.9.2 Pressure-release device. A pressure-release device shall be provided where the use of pressure lubricating equipment will damage grease seals or other parts.

3.9.3 Filling, draining, and checking provisions. Enclosures such as gear cases and transmission housings that contain a reservoir of lubricants for the lubrication of the parts enclosed shall be equipped with dipsticks, check plugs not less than 1/2-inch pipe size, or sight gages to determine the level of the lubricant. Each enclosure shall be equipped for filling the enclosure with a lubricant and for draining. The drain outlet shall be fitted with a drain plug conforming to MS35844 or MS49006. The drain outlet shall be located so that removal of the plug will result in complete drainage of the lubricant from the enclosure. Integral tubes or troughs shall be used to convey the lubricant from the drain outlet to the disposal area.

3.10 Items to be furnished with the pier barge. No shipment of pier barge(s) shall be made unless repair parts, tools, and accessories (see 6.2) are included with the shipment or unless approval for shipment of the pier barge without such items has been received from the contracting officer.

3.11 Pier barges and accessory items. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), pier barges and accessory items shall be furnished by the contractor in the quantities specified (see 6.2).

3.12 Type I pier barge.

3.12.1 Air compressor units. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), air compressors shall be furnished by the contractor in the quantities specified (see 6.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Each unit shall produce not less than 425 cubic feet per minute (cfm) at not less than 350 psi air pressure. Each unit shall deliver not less than its rated capacity in cubic feet of free air per minute at conditions prevailing at the compressor intake, while operating with automatic controls and when pumping continuously against a receiver pressure of not less than 350 psi pressure. Each unit shall be complete with the accessories necessary to maintain the regulated capacity, and shall be enclosed in a sheet metal housing, and skid mounted.

3.12.1.1 Air tanks. Tanks shall conform to the ASME Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code for Unfired Pressure Vessels.

3.12.2 Elevating jacks. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), elevating jacks and their controls shall be furnished by the contractor in the quantities specified (see 6.2). Each jack shall be capable of lifting and lowering a load of not less than 450 short tons at a rate of not less than 12 feet per hour without interruption and of holding the load for not less than 24 hours. The lifting, lowering, or holding the load for not less than 24 hours. The lifting, lowering, or holding operations shall be accomplished without slippage, damage, or permanent deformation to any part of the jack or caisson. When installed on the pier barge, jacks shall be capable of individual or simultaneous operation from a central control station. When operated simultaneously, jacks shall lift the pier barge a vertical distance of not less than 25 feet at a rate of not less than 12 feet per hour and then lower the pier barge to its starting position without slippage, damage or permanent deformation to any part of the jacks, caissons, or pier barge. To achieve the required jacking speed, it will require the installation of one air compressor for every two jacks installed.

3.12.3 Government-furnished property. Unless otherwise specified the following property in the quantities indicated will be furnished by the Government (see 6.4).

Item No.	Description	Identification	Quantity
1	Compressor, air	425 cu. ft. at 350 psi	As required
2	Jack, air	450 short tons at 12 ft/hr	As required
3	Control panel	Master control unit	As required
4	Control panel	Individual control unit	As required

3.12.4 Government-loaned property. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2) the following property in the quantities indicated will be loaned by the Government (see 6.4).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Item No.	Description	Identification	Quantity
1	Compressor, air	425 cu. ft. at 350 psi	5
2	Jack, air	450 short tons at 12 ft/hr	10
3	Control panel	Master control unit	1
4	Control panel	Individual control unit	1 per jack

3.13 Workmanship.

3.13.1 Welding. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), welding shall conform to ABS Rules for Building and Classing Steel Vessels.

3.13.2 Sequence. Welding of the hull structure shall be such that the transverse welds and butt welds shall be completed before longitudinal seams and longitudinal welds are made. All longitudinal, transverse and vertical welding in an erection unit must be completed before circumferential butt and connection butts or longitudinal bulkheads are welded. Proposed welding sequence shall be submitted by the contractor and approved by the contracting officer before construction is started (see 6.2).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Component and material inspection. The contractor is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with referenced specifications, standards, and drawings, as applicable.

4.1.2 Disassembly inspection. Any machinery or equipment failing a performance test shall be disassembled in the presence of a Government representative. Each disassembled part shall be examined in detail for compliance with this specification and reference drawings in regard to materials, dimensions, tolerances, and workmanship. Parts not complying with such requirements shall be cause for rejection. Government-furnished or Government-loaned property shall be excluded from the requirement of this paragraph.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.1.3 Parts and components. Parts and components detailed on the drawings shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions (QAP) shown on the drawings. The drawings specify the characteristics requiring QAP inspection, the sampling plan, and the basis for acceptance and rejection (see 6.7 and 6.8).

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows.

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).

b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

c. Inspection of packaging (see 4.6).

4.3 First article inspection.

4.3.1 Examination. The first article pier barge shall be examined as specified in 4.5.1. Presence of one or more defects shall be cause for rejection.

4.3.2 Tests. The first article pier barge shall be tested as specified in 4.5.2. Failure of any test shall be cause for performing the disassembly inspection specified in 4.1.2.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection.

4.4.1 Examination. Each pier barge shall be examined as specified in 4.5.1. Presence of one or more defects shall be cause for rejection.

4.4.2 Tests. Each pier barge shall be tested as specified in 4.5.2. Failure of military design components shall be cause for performing the inspection specified in 4.1.2. Failure of any test shall be cause for rejection.

4.5 Inspection procedure.

4.5.1 Examination. The pier barge shall be examined as specified herein for the following defects:

101. Components and materials not as specified.
102. Materials are not corrosion resistant or treated to be made corrosion resistant for the applicable storage and operating environment.
103. Dissimilar metals as defined in MIL-STD-889 are not effectively insulated from each other.
104. Contractor does not have documentation available for identification of material, material finishes or treatments.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

105. Safety devices not provided as specified.
106. Maintainability not as specified.
107. Pier barge construction not as specified.
108. Electromagnetic interference suppression components and network not identical with approved model.
109. Provisions for lubrication not as specified.
110. Items to be furnished with pier barge not as specified.
111. Identification and draft markings not as specified.
112. Treatment and painting not as specified.
113. Air tanks not as specified.
114. Workmanship not in accordance with, or does not conform to drawings or ABS Rules for Building and Classing Steel Vessels.
115. Welding not in accordance with or does not conform to drawings or ABS Rules for Building and Classing Steel Vessels.
116. Welding sequence not as specified or other than approved sequence.
117. Welding operators not qualified as specified.

4.5.2 Tests.

4.5.2.1 Noise level measurement. Measure the sound level at three feet from the unit at a height of 65 inches in accordance with MIL-STD-1474 for steady state noise. The compressor unit shall be operated at rated capacity, with the escaping air piped away from the test site. If the sound level of the compressor unit delivering rated capacity at the three foot distance exceeds 85dB(A), the distance from the compressor unit at which the 85dB(A) is met shall be determined, and properly stated on noise hazard caution signs as specified in paragraph 3.5. Nonconformance to 3.5 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.5.2.2 Compartments. Each compartment shall be subjected to 3 psi air pressure for not less than six hours. Any evidence of leaks shall constitute failure of this test.

4.5.2.3 Air compressor. When furnished by the contractor, each air compressor shall be operated for one hour producing not less than 425 cfm of air at 350 psi pressure. The air compressor unit capacity shall be determined by the ASME Low Pressure Nozzle Method of the Power Test Code (PTC No. 9(1954)) for Displacement Compressors, Vacuum Pumps, and Blowers. Air tanks shall be tested for conformance to 3.12.1.1. The air tank shall be marked or stamped with an ASME official code U-symbol and the contractor shall submit a copy of the ASME data sheet (Form U-1) to the contracting officer. Failure of the air compressor and air tanks to conform to 3.12.1 and 3.12.1.1 for one hour, or failure of the air tanks to contain the ASME marking, or disapproval of the ASME data sheet shall constitute failure of this test.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.2.4 Dock trial jacking test. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2) after a pier barge is waterborne, it shall be made ready for a jacking test. Jacks shall be operated individually and simultaneously by the control panel for not less than 30 minutes to insure jacks and controls are functioning as required for the application. This test shall be made by lowering and raising caissons through a distance from bottom shell to water floor. The pier barge then shall be raised a vertical distance of not less than 25 feet at not less than 12 feet per hour with all jacks in simultaneous operation and then lowered to its starting position with all jacks operating simultaneously. After successful completion of jack operation, the following test shall be performed: Each jack shall lift a load of 450 short tons at not less than 12 feet per hour for a vertical distance of not less than 25 feet without interruption (see 6.9). The load shall then be held for a 24 hour period after which it shall be lowered to its original position at a speed equal to the lifting speed. Jacking speeds shall be measured and recorded for this test. Failure to raise or lower the caissons or pier barge as specified, or any slippage, damage or permanent deformation to any part of jacks, caissons or pier barge shall constitute failure of this test.

4.5.2.5 Compressed air system. All main air piping shall be subjected to 350 psi air pressure for not less than six hours. All tubing control lines shall be subjected to 175 psi air pressure for not less than six hours. Any evidence of leaks shall constitute failure of this test.

4.5.2.6 Caissons. For each caisson, all weld joints shall be ultrasonically tested to insure 100 percent peneration. Weld testing shall be in accordance with ABS standards. An ABS certificate certifying that 100 percent weld penetration has been achieved shall be provided by the contractor.

4.5.2.7 Lighting system.

4.5.2.7.1 Insulation. Each electrical circuit shall be subjected to insulation resistance tests. The resistance between conductors and between conductor and the ground shall not be less than the following. Failure to meet these requirements shall constitute failure of this test.

a.	Up to 25 ampere load	- 400,000 ohms
b.	Up to 50 ampere load	- 250,000 ohms
c.	Up to 100 ampere load	- 100,000 ohms
d.	Up to 200 ampere load	- 50,000 ohms
e.	Over 200 ampere load	- 25,000 ohms

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.2.7.2 Voltage drop. Circuits shall be tested to determine that all lighting fixtures, receptacles and other connected fittings are in suitable operating condition. The voltage drop from transformer secondary to each lamp receptacle shall not be greater than 3 percent of the transformer secondary voltage with all lamps burning. The voltage drop from the shore connection terminals to any transformer primary terminal shall not be greater than 3 percent of the voltage at the shore connection terminal with all lamps burning. Failure of the voltage drop to remain within a 3 percent range shall constitute failure of this test.

4.5.2.8 Electromagnetic interference. The first pier barge produced, equipped for the reduction of electromagnetic interference in accordance with MIL-STD-461, shall be tested in accordance with MIL-STD-461, class C1, group II. The contractor shall furnish the contracting officer the reports required by MIL-STD-461 at the time interval specified (see 6.2). Upon approval of the reports by the contracting officer and provided all other requirements of the specification are met, the first pier barge produced shall be used as a model for all production pier barges. Disapproval of the report shall be cause for rejection.

4.5.2.9 Ramp. Tests shall be conducted in accordance with 55-1945-BPL-6710-RAMP. Failure of any test shall be cause for rejection.

4.6 Inspection of packaging.

4.6.1 Examination. Each pier barge shall be examined for the following defects. One or more defects shall be cause for rejection.

118. Materials, methods, or containers not as specified.
119. Matchmarking not as specified.
120. Unprotected surfaces not preserved and wrapped or covered as applicable, as specified.
121. Electrical openings not sealed as specified.
122. Control panels not preserved as specified.
123. Floodlight standards not lowered and secured, and the lights not boxed and protected as specified.
124. Air compressor not preserved in accordance with the referenced document as specified.
125. Removable equipment and gear not packed as specified.
126. Air compressor not secured and protected with a housing as specified.
127. Manhole covers and hatches not closed and secured as specified.
128. Depreservation guide not prepared and attached as specified.
129. Marking not in accordance with the referenced standard and specific requirements as specified.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 General requirements. Each complete barge with furnished equipment shall be provided adequate protection to prevent deterioration and damage against the most severe conditions known or anticipated to be encountered during shipment and indeterminate storage. Preservation and packing of components for which no specific requirements are specified herein, shall be determined by the contractor using the criteria established in MIL-P-116 and the applicable requirements of TB 740-97-4 as guidance.

5.1.1 Preservation (see 6.11).

5.1.1.1 Disassembly. Disassembly shall be the minimum necessary to safeguard components vulnerable to damage, pilferage, and loss. Disassembly shall be confined to those components that can be easily removed and reinstalled without special tools or skilled personnel. Removed bolts, nuts, pins, screws, washers, etc. shall be reinstalled in mating parts and secured to prevent loss.

5.1.1.2 Matchmarking. When necessary to facilitate reassembly, removed parts and mating parts shall be matchmarked. Matchmarking information shall be placed on tags conforming to UU-T-81, type A and the tags attached to mating parts. The information on the tags shall be applied in waterproof ink.

5.1.1.3 Preservatives and methods of preservation. Preservatives identified herein by "P" numbers shall conform to applicable specifications listed in, and shall be applied in accordance with, MIL-P-116. Methods of preservation specified shall conform to procedures, materials, and techniques specified in MIL-P-116.

5.1.1.4 Unprotected sufaces.

5.1.1.4.1 Unfinished surfaces. Unpainted, unfinished metal surfaces of the deck equipment and the gear and any other similar parts and equipment requiring the applicaton of a contact preservative in accordance with MIL-P-116, shall be coated with type P-1 preservative.

5.1.1.4.2 Machined surfaces. Exposed machined surfaces of parts shall be coated with type P-6 or P-11 preservative and wrapped or covered with barrier material conforming to MIL-B-121, type I, grade A, class 2, secured in place with tape conforming to MIL-T-22085, type II.

5.1.1.5 Electrical openings. Openings into electrical boxes, receptacles, and similar components shall be sealed with tape conforming to MIL-T-22085, type II.

5.1.1.6 Control panels. The master and individual control panels shall be separately preserved in accordance with MIL-P-116, method 1A-14. The inner box

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

shall be the contractor's commercial container or a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic, variety and grade as applicable. The outer box shall conform to PPP-B-636, type CF, class weather-resistant, variety and grade as applicable.

5.1.1.7 Floodlights. The light standards will be lowered and secured to the deck. The floodlights shall be removed, placed in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-621, class 2, style optional or PPP-B-601, overseas type, style optional and blocked, braced, cushioned or anchored as applicable to prevent damage.

5.1.1.8 Air compressor. Each complete air compressor shall be preserved in accordance with the level A requirements of MIL-C-3600.

5.1.2 Packing (see 6.11).

5.1.2.1 Removable equipment and gear. Removable equipment and gear, preserved as specified in 5.1 and 5.1.1, except that which is used for mooring or moving, shall be stowed in the cargo hold as space permits. Items that will not fit in the cargo hold and require the protection afforded by a wood box to prevent pilferage, damage, loss, or for ease or securing, shall be packed in a minimum number of boxes conforming to PPP-B-601, overseas type, style I or J, or PPP-B-621, class 2, style optional. The boxes shall be of a size and configuration most suitable for securing to the barge. Blocking, bracing, anchoring or cushioning of the contents within the boxes shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1186. The boxes shall be secured to the barge in a manner that will not interfere with mooring or moving. Securement shall be with strapping conforming to QQ-S-781, class 1, type I or IV, finish B, or by any other suitable means that will prevent movement. Items that will not fit in the cargo hold and do not require a wood box for protection shall be secured as specifed herein, for boxes.

5.1.2.2 Air compressors. Each air compressor shall be anchored to the deck of the barge by using a device constructed from steel and fabricated for this purpose. The anchoring device shall be welded to the pier barge deck. Each complete compressor shall be protected by a wood housing consisting of two ends, two sides, and a top constructed in accordance with PPP-B-601, overseas type, style I or J.

5.1.2.3 Manhole covers and hatches. All manhole covers and hatches shall be closed and secured.

5.1.2.4 Depreservation guide. Two copies of depreservation guide conforming to DA Form 2258, Depreservation Guide for Vehicles and Equipment (see 6.10) shall be furnished for each air compressor. One copy shall be placed in a waterproof

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

envelope and conspicuously attached to the engine or compressor under the hood of the air compressor unit and one copy shall be furnished to the contracting officer. Prior to completion of the DA Form 2258, line five under the column heading "DEPRESERVATION REQUIRED" shall read as follows: DRAIN AND REFILL WITH OPERATING LUBRICANT. If the furnished form does not read accordingly, it shall be changed by use of corrosion tape or an adhesive label which displays the above warning.

5.2 Marking. In addition to any special marking specified (see 6.2) and as specified herein, the pier barge shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.2.1 Removable equipment and gear. Removable equipment and gear shall be marked indicating the nomenclature and operating location. Marking shall be by stenciling or tagging.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Pier barges are intended to be used to form a platform providing docking and intermediate loading and unloading facilities for all types of vessels. Type I barges are self-elevating barges used at or close to shore line. They are rapidly elevated and installed, and put into operation as single or multiple pier units with provisions for approach spans and electrical flood lighting. Type II barges do not have air jacks and are used in deeper waters to unload deep draft ships. The pier barges are capable of being towed to various parts of the world.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.

b. Type of pier barge required (see 1.2).

c. Length of caisson required (see 3.1.1).

d. When a ramp is required (see 3.1.2).

e. When a first article is required (see 3.2).

f. Items to be furnished with the pier barge (see 3.10).

g. When pier barges and accessory items are not to be furnished by the contractor (see 3.11).

h. Quantity of each of the following items to be furnished (see 3.11).

(1) Pier barges.
(2) Corner guards.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(3) Guard rail, type and number of pieces.
(4) Number of fenders (wood).
(5) Type and number of fenders (tire).
(6) Bridge spans.
(7) Bridge span support brackets.
(8) Piles.
(9) Pile caps.
(10) "T" plates, type and number of pieces.

i. When electrical system is to be furnished (see 3.11).

j. Quantity of air compressors to be furnished by the contractor (see 3.12.1).

k. When air compressors are not to be furnished (see 3.12.1).

l. When elevating jacks and controls are not to be furnished (see 3.12.2).

m. Quantity of elevating jacks and controls to be furnished, when applicable (see 3.12.4).

n. When welding shall be other than specified (see 3.13.1).

o. Time frame when welding sequence shall be furnished (see 3.13.2).

p. When dock trial jacking test is not required (see 4.5.2.4).

q. Time interval required for submission of electromagnetic interference reports (see 4.5.2.8).

r. When special marking is required (see 5.2).

6.3 First article. When a first article inspection is required, the item will be tested and should be a first produced pier barge. The first article should consist of one unit. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, test approval of the documents first article.

6.4 Government property. The contracting officer shall determine whether Government-furnished property, Government-loaned property, or both shall be furnished. Property furnished or loaned by the Government shall be tested by the contractor in accordance with 4.5.2.3 or 4.5.2.4 as applicable unless otherwise specified by the contracting officer. Such property failing these tests shall be the responsibility of the Government.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.4.1 Government-furnished property. When required, the contracting officer shall arrange to furnish the property specified in 3.12.3 and in the quantity required.

6.4.2 Government-loaned property. When required the contracting officer shall arrange to loan the property specified in 3.12.4.

6.5 Data requirements. The contracting officer should include requirements for such data as technical publications, instructional materials, illustrated parts lists, and contractor's maintenance and operation manual to be furnished with each pier barge.

6.6 Provisioning. The contracting officer should include provisioning requirements for repair parts and maintenance tools as necessary (including any special tools), and instructions regarding shipment of each pier barge.

6.7 Quality assurance provisions (QAP). The contracting officer should require the contractor to maintain records of all QAP inspections. A suggested paragraph is as follows:

"The contractor shall maintain complete records of all examinations and tests performed to verify the requirements of classified QAP characteristics. The records shall include, as a minimum, lot size, sample size, drawing requirements, actual measurements, number and type of deficiencies found, quantity approved, quantity rejected, and corrective action taken when applicable."

6.8 Definitions.

6.8.1 Quality assurance provisions (QAP). A QAP is a contractual requirement that supplements section 4 of the specification. QAP's indicate the minimum requirements which must be inspected on the project drawings to verify the design objectives of the product and assure interchangeability of repair parts.

6.9 Jacking speed. Jacking speed of 12 feet per hour is completely dependent on the ratio of 1 air compressor per 2 airjacks (i.e. 6 airjacks require 3 air compressors to obtain a jacking rate of 12 feet per hour).

6.10 DA Form 2258. The contracting officer should arrange to furnish DA Form 2258, Depreservation Guide for Vehicles and Equipment, when requested by the contractor.

6.11 Preservation and packing. Degree of preservation and packing have not been included as the barge is subjected continually to climatic conditions that require the highest degree of preservation.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.12 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used, when practical, as long as it meets the requirements of this specification (see 3.3).

Custodian:
Army - ME

Preparing activity:
Army - ME

Project 1945-A044

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-B-52620A(ME)	Barge, Pier Self-Elevating, Steel, 300 Feet by 80 Feet by 13 Feet

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION

b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*

4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*

- ☐ VENDOR
- ☐ USER
- ☐ MANUFACTURER
- ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

(TO DETACH THIS FORM, CUT ALONG THIS LINE.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.